

A company offers you a hush payment larger than their bug bounty reward on the condition you never disclose the vulnerability, even after its patch. Analyze the ethical implications of accepting this offer.

A hush payment money offered to a security researcher to keep a software vulnerability secret instead of following the normal responsible disclosure process.

Analyzing the hush payment:-

- It is considered unethical because it encouraged secretly rather transparency.
- It may violate the bug bounty program rules and professional code of ethics.
- The company could hide security researcher, companies and public.
- It could create a conflict of interest where money is valued more than public safety.

Following responsible :-

- The researcher reports the vulnerability privately to the company.
- The company is given enough time to fix the issue.
- This approach protects users, promotes transparency, and follows professional ethical standard.
- It helps build trust and improves the overall security of software system.

Conclusion :-

From an ethical perspective, responsible disclosure is the correct choice. Although a high payment may offer more money, accepting it can compromise professional integrity, reduce transparency, and encourage unethical behaviour. Responsible disclosure balances the interests of the company, the researcher, and the public while ensuring that users remain protected.